

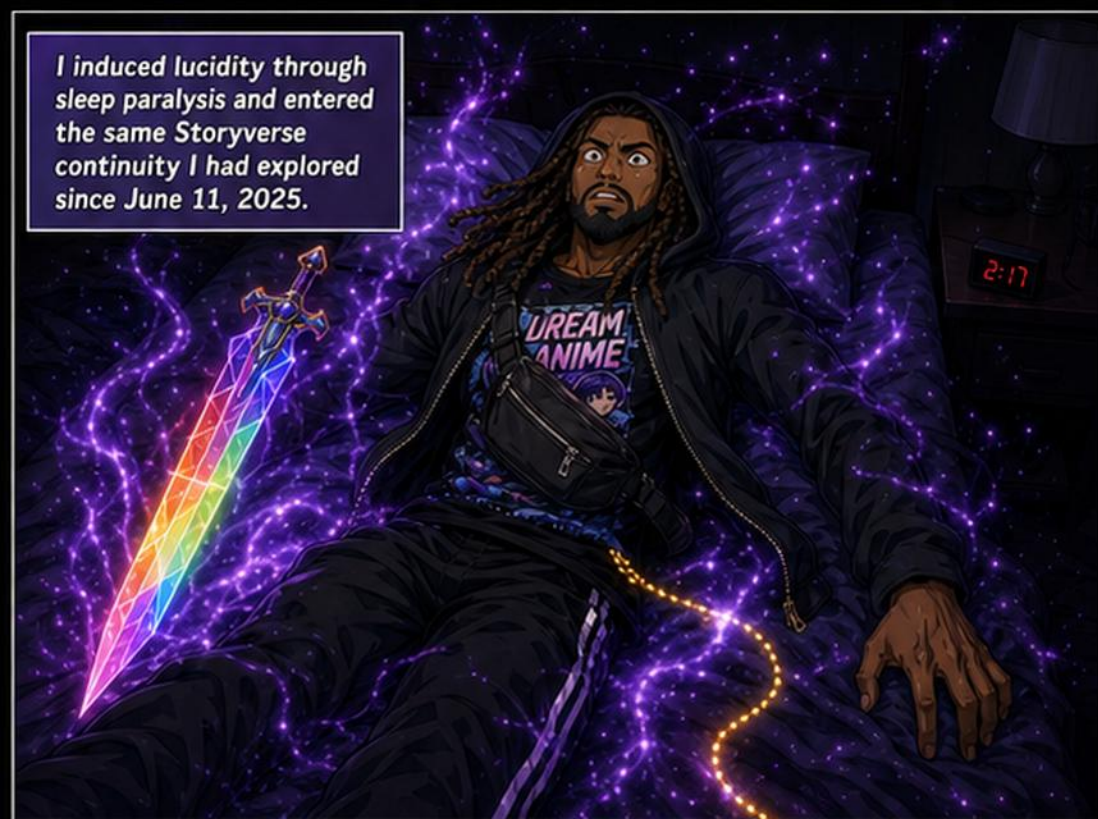


THE CLONE IN THE VOID

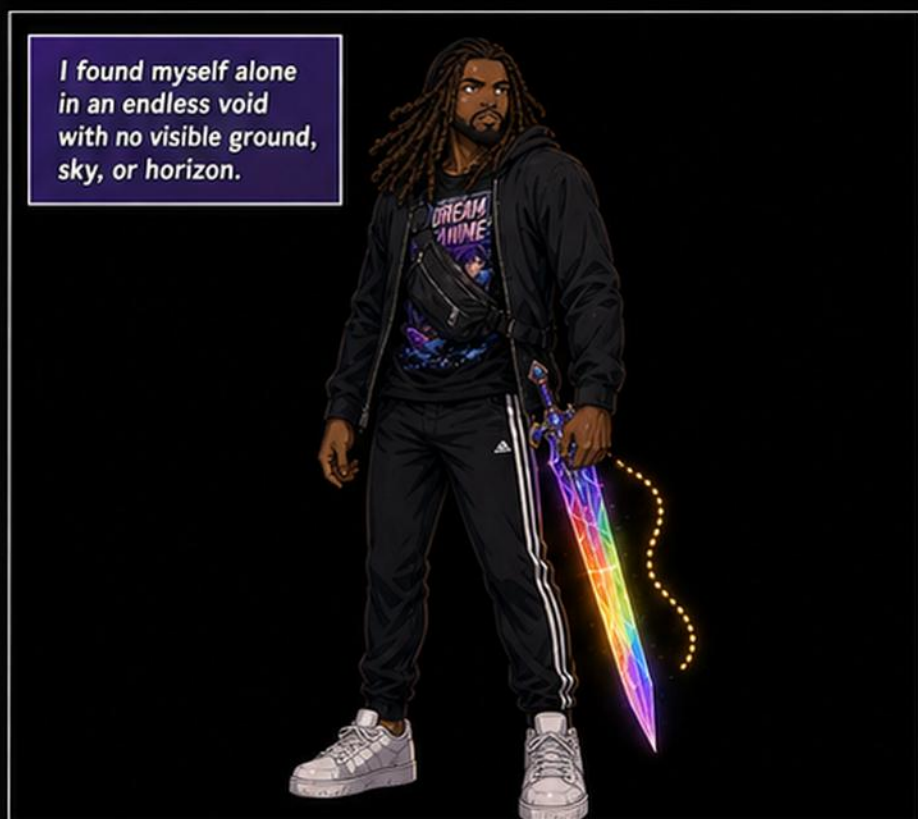
SUPERHERO RECRUITMENT DRIVE

JULY 25, 2026

I induced lucidity through sleep paralysis and entered the same Storyverse continuity I had explored since June 11, 2025.



I found myself alone in an endless void with no visible ground, sky, or horizon.



A man sat at an ordinary table and told me he was involved with comic books, so I joined him.



When he asked for a pitch, I considered promoting a comic idea that my friend wanted to create.

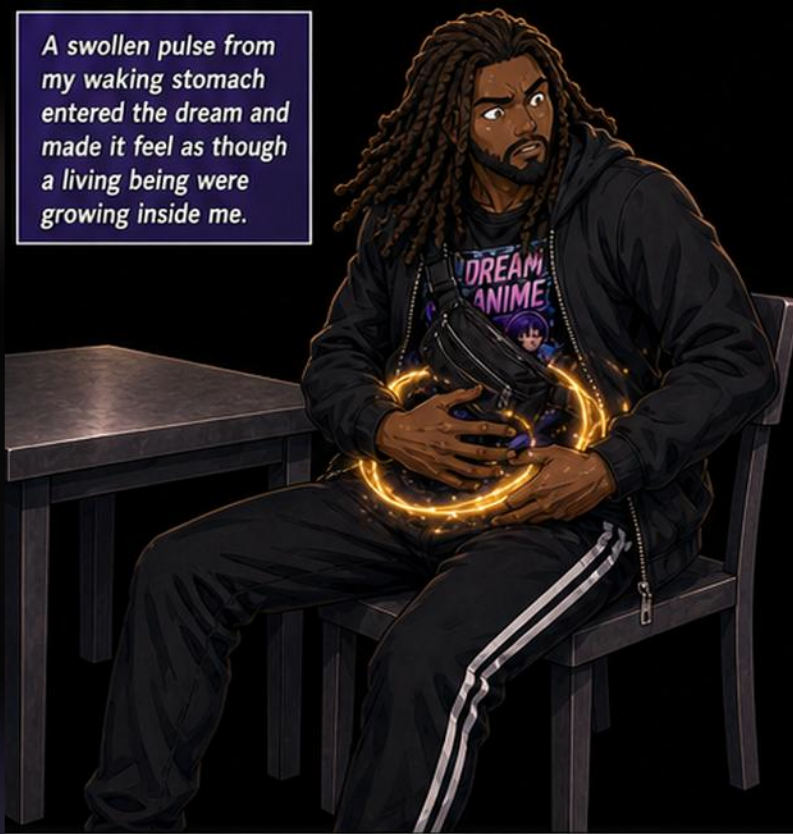


He admitted that he worked for no publisher. He could only message one and recommend creators he believed deserved attention.

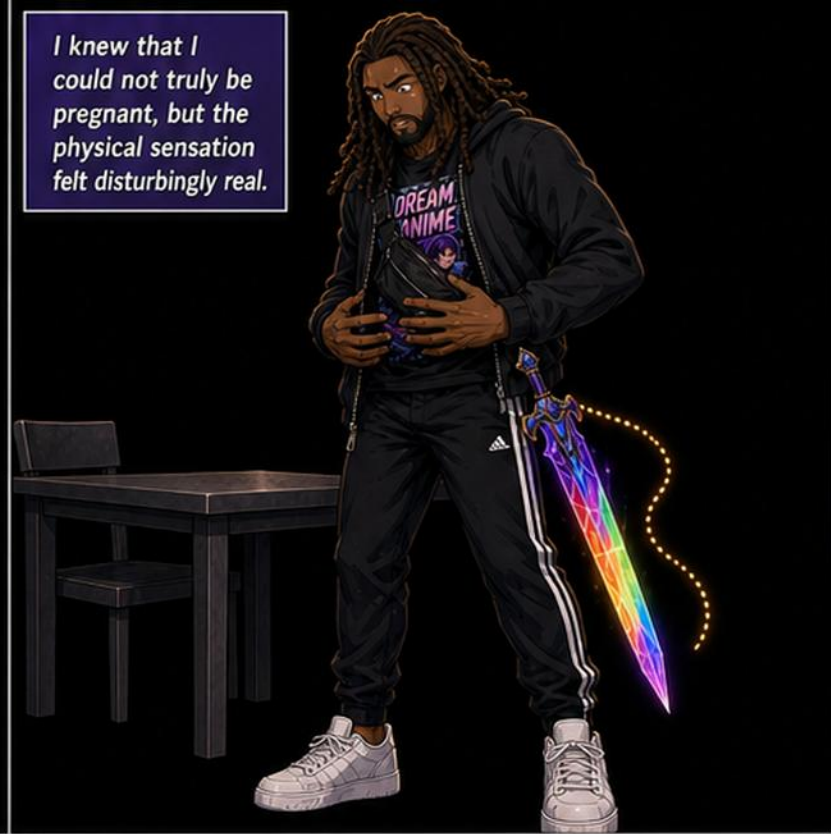


His offer sounded potentially useful, but I still did not know how much influence he truly possessed.

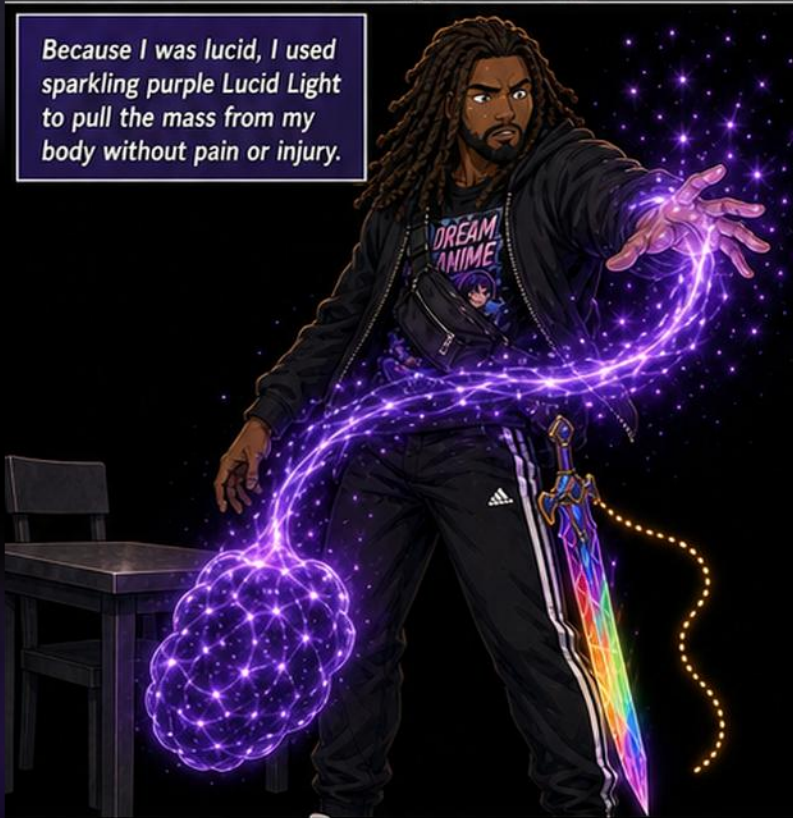
A swollen pulse from my waking stomach entered the dream and made it feel as though a living being were growing inside me.



I knew that I could not truly be pregnant, but the physical sensation felt disturbingly real.



Because I was lucid, I used sparkling purple Lucid Light to pull the mass from my body without pain or injury.



It became a large black cocoon, and a glowing humanoid silhouette was visible through its surface.



Before I could understand it, the comic-book man transformed into a massive, animalistic rat monster.



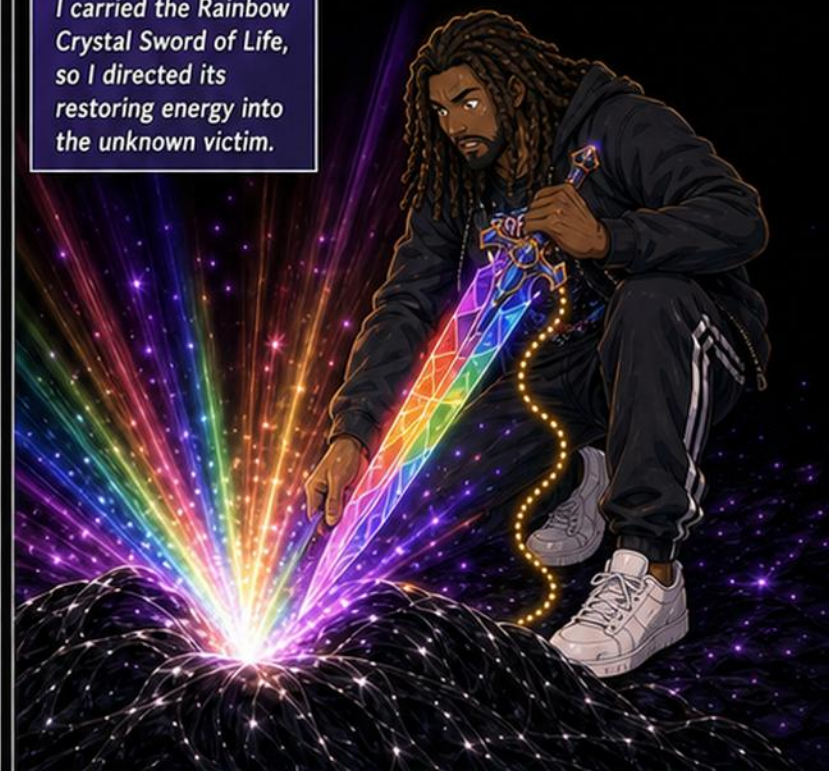
The creature pummeled the being inside the bag again and again, then scurried away into the darkness.



The rat fled like a wild animal and left me alone with the battered cocoon.



I carried the Rainbow Crystal Sword of Life, so I directed its restoring energy into the unknown victim.



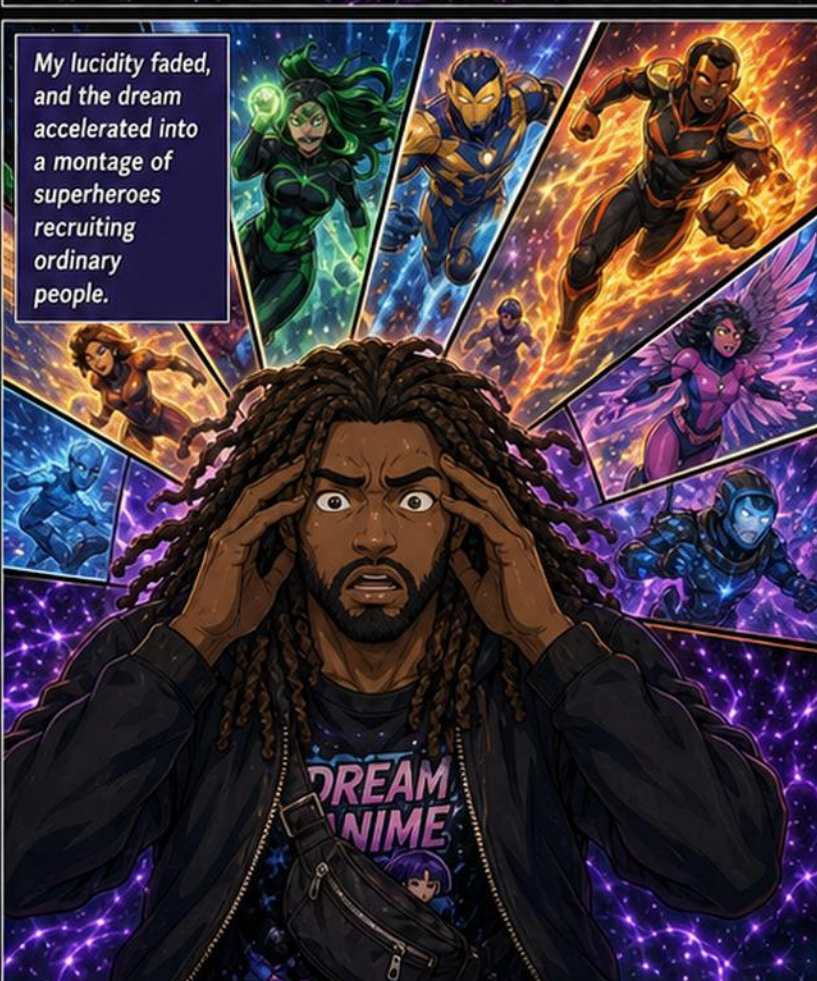
Rainbow light repaired the body, and the black material split open without blood or gore.



The being I had revived was an exact clone of me—another Jet wearing my own face and clothes.



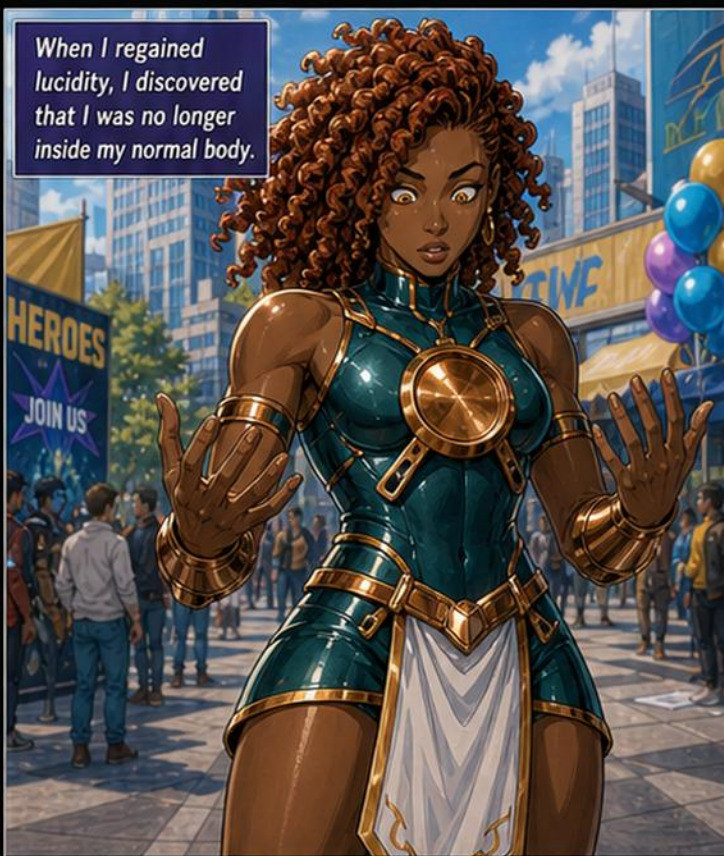
My lucidity faded, and the dream accelerated into a montage of superheroes recruiting ordinary people.



Many people were confused at first, but some began to understand that becoming a hero could be a choice.



When I regained lucidity, I discovered that I was no longer inside my normal body.



I had become a woman in a teal-and-copper superhero suit, apparently one of the heroes leading the recruitment drive.



Although the body and face were unfamiliar, my awareness remained completely my own. Internally, I was still Jet.

I approached someone who seemed like a possible recruit, only to discover that they were already a shapeshifting supervillain.



The shapeshifter copied the female hero I was inhabiting, creating an exact duplicate of my current appearance.



Only the duplicate's magenta telekinetic aura revealed which of us was the attacker.



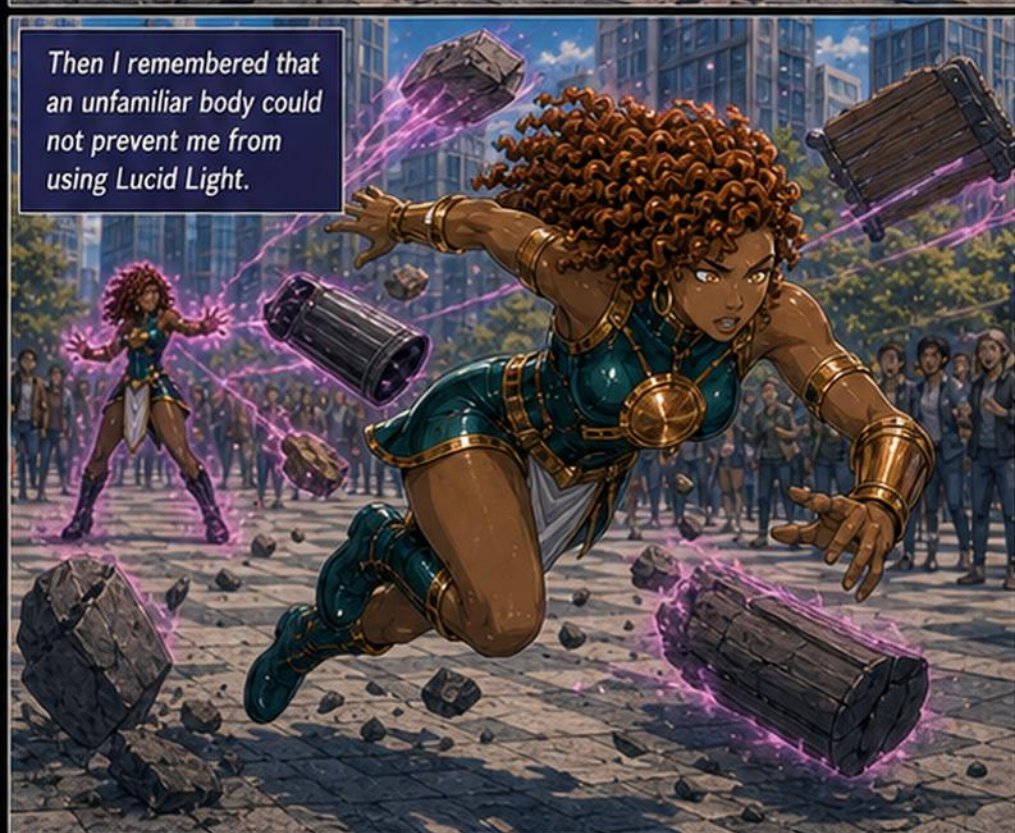
The duplicate possessed telekinesis and attacked me from a distance without needing to come close.



I struggled to escape the flying objects and force waves while searching for a way to fight back.



Then I remembered that an unfamiliar body could not prevent me from using Lucid Light.



Sparkling purple power gathered around my hands, ready to become whatever my lucid mind demanded.



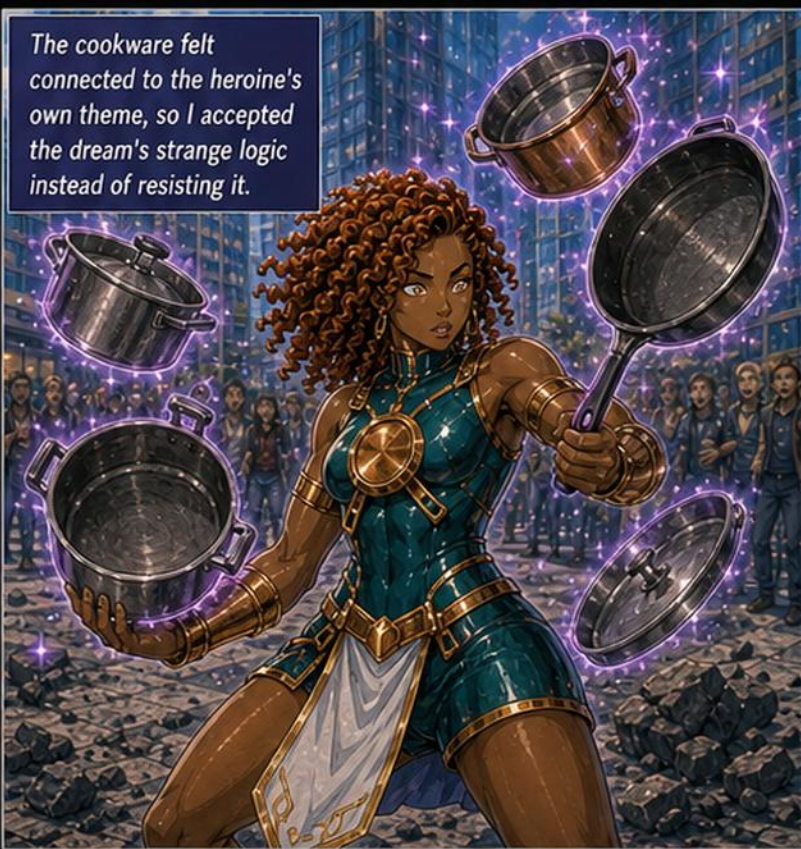
For reasons I did not yet understand, I manifested an assortment of pots and pans.



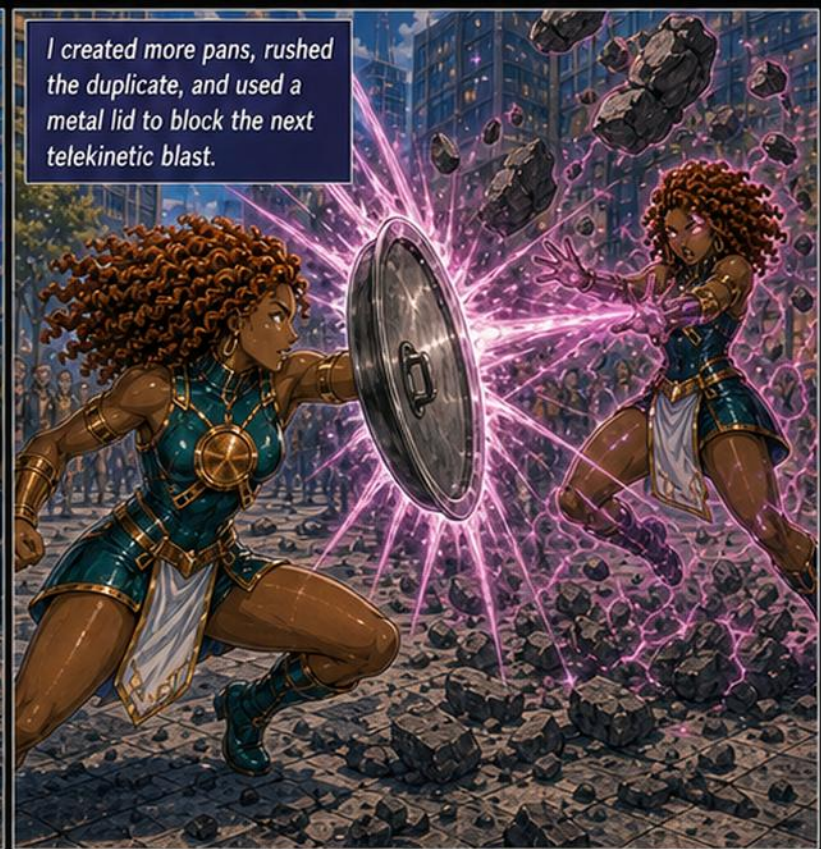
The absurd attack caught the shapeshifter completely off guard and broke their telekinetic rhythm.



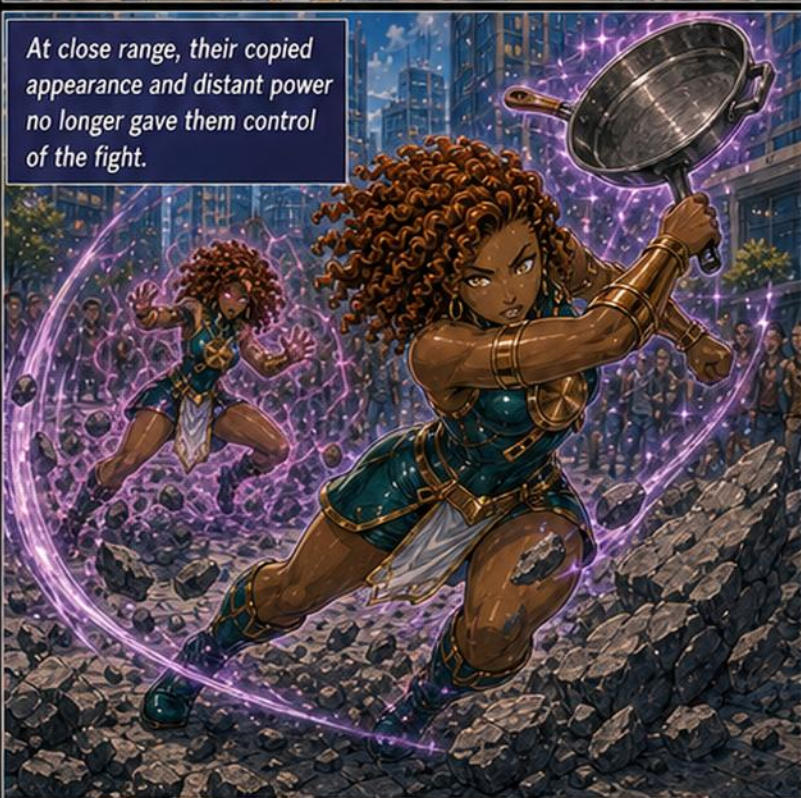
The cookware felt connected to the heroine's own theme, so I accepted the dream's strange logic instead of resisting it.



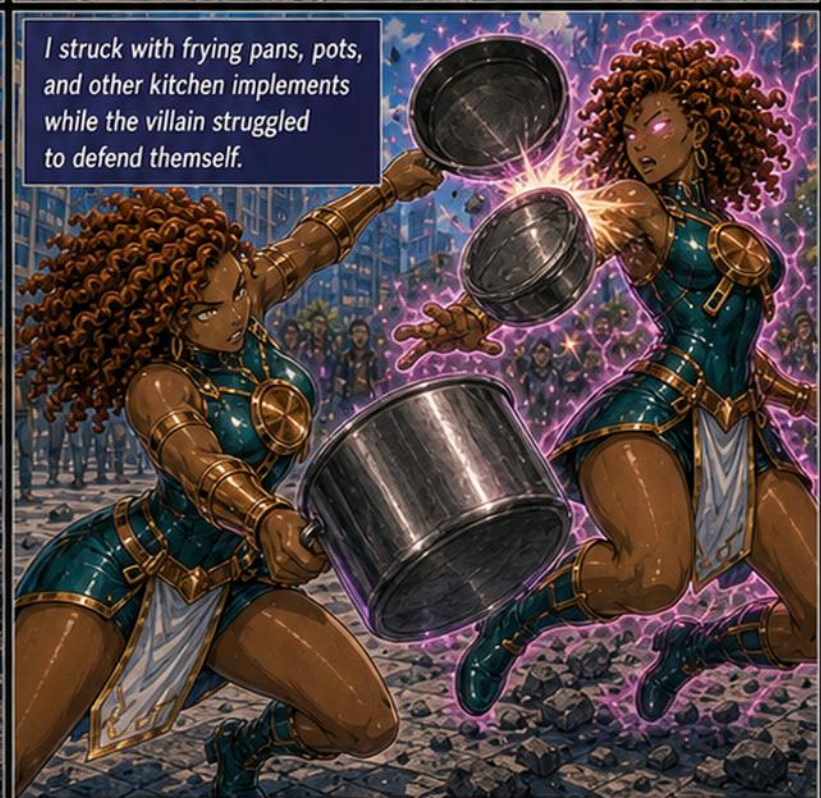
I created more pans, rushed the duplicate, and used a metal lid to block the next telekinetic blast.



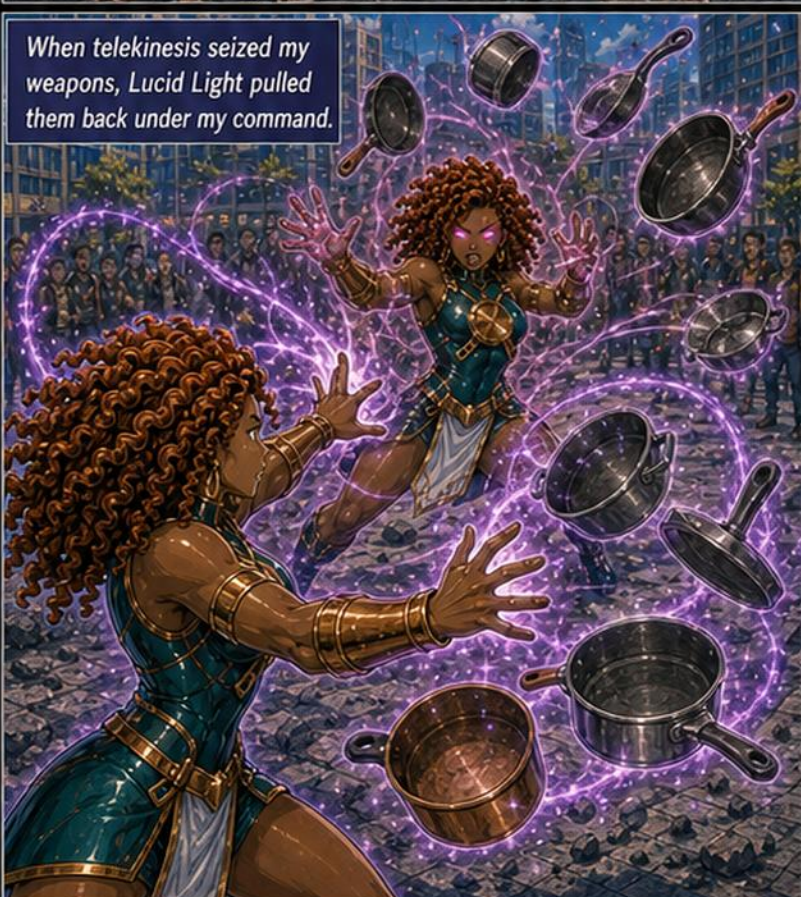
At close range, their copied appearance and distant power no longer gave them control of the fight.



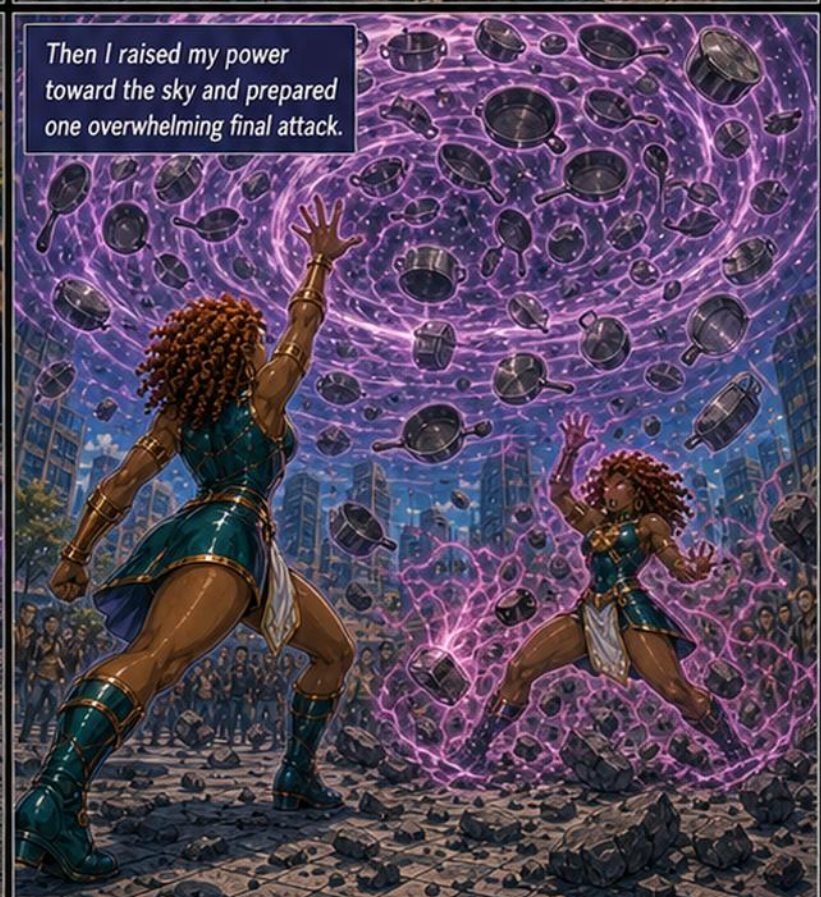
I struck with frying pans, pots, and other kitchen implements while the villain struggled to defend herself.



When telekinesis seized my weapons, Lucid Light pulled them back under my command.



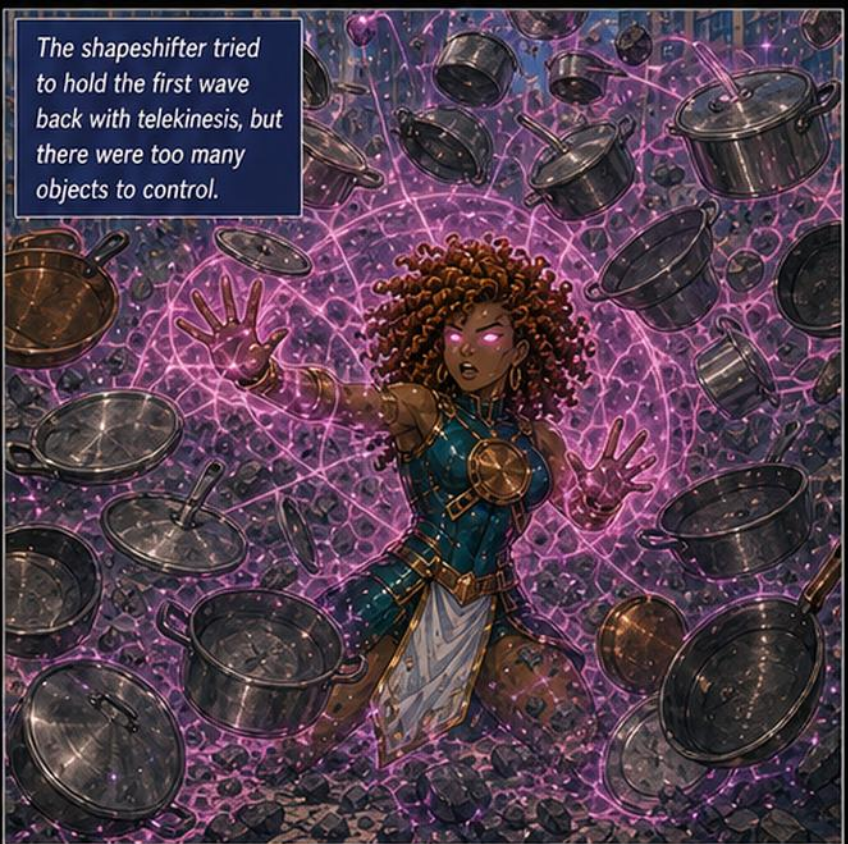
Then I raised my power toward the sky and prepared one overwhelming final attack.



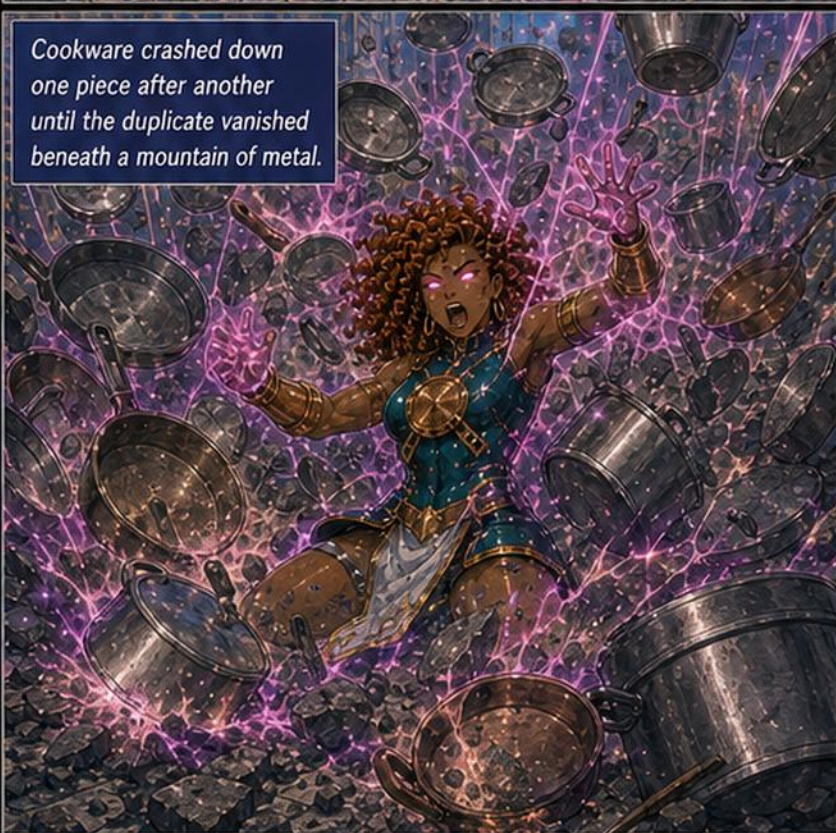
Hundreds of pots and pans gathered above us inside a massive storm of Lucid Light.



The shapeshifter tried to hold the first wave back with telekinesis, but there were too many objects to control.



Cookware crashed down one piece after another until the duplicate vanished beneath a mountain of metal.



The villain had copied my temporary body, but they could not copy the lucid awareness that made my choices my own.



With the shapeshifter completely defeated, my alarm began to sound.



The recruitment drive dissolved, the Storyverse released me, and I woke up.

